

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 3
♥ A Q 7
♦ J 10 8 7 3
♣ K 6

♠ A Q 10

♥ K 4 3

♦ K Q 9 2

♣ Q 8 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 8 5 2

♥ J 10 6 5 2

♦ 6 4

♣ 9 3

♠ J 6 4

♥ 9 8

♦ A 5

♣ A J 10 7 4 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

If his honor is not the ♥K then it won't matter whether you play ♥A or ♥Q to the first trick; you will win your two top cards and then play your small one back to East.

So assume North actually holds the ♥K x x. If you play the ♥A to trick one, then lead ♥Q, North will hold up on the second trick, and win the third ♥. Then, when you win your ♣K you will not have a ♥ to return to partner and declarer will make the contract.

So what happens if you play the ♥Q at trick one? North could still make the contract by holding up, **but he will be afraid to do so**. After all, from his perspective it looks like East probably holds the ♥A and he will be afraid of losing the first 5 ♥ tricks, perhaps even when the ♣K finessing is working!

[showcards W:H5 N:H8]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥8

Play the ♥Q.

The Rule of Eleven tells you there are 6 cards in South, West and North that are higher than the ♥5. You can see 5 of them, so that leaves just one of them for North.

East cannot have all three of the outstanding honors, because from ♥K J 10 x x his correct lead would be the Jack. So you can deduce that North must hold exactly one of ♥K, ♥J, or ♥10.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 5
 ♥ Q J 9 7 2
 ♦ A Q 6
 ♣ 9 7 3

♠ A J 8 3

♥ 10 6

♦ 7 5 2

♣ A K Q 5



♠ 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ 10 9 8 4

♣ 10 8 4 2

♠ Q 10 9 6 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ K J 3

♣ J 6

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

1♣

Pass

1♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

put you back on lead with your ♥A. You play the ♦9 and your side will collect 3 ♦ tricks to go with your 2♥s.

[showcards W:HQ N:H6]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥Q, dummy played the ♥6

Overtake with the ♥K.

Your side needs to take 5 tricks to defeat this contract. Two of them will be ♥s, but it doesn't look like you can win any ♣s or ♠s.

That means you need to win 3 ♦ tricks and the only way that can happen is if you play ♦s from your side.

So win the first ♥K (so partner will know you also have the ♥A), and play the ♦10. Presumably South will play an honor, but West will take the trick and

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10
 ♥ 7 3 2
 ♦ 9 8 6 3
 ♣ Q 7 5 4 3

♠ 9 7 5 2

♥ A 10 9 5 4

♦ J

♣ K 10 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K Q 8 6 4

♥ 8

♦ 7 4 2

♣ A J 9

♠ J 3

♥ K Q J 6

♦ A K Q 10 5

♣ 6 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

1♥

1♠

1♦

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

from your side of the table, and the way to make that happen is for you to ruff partner's ♠K with an otherwise useless trump. You still get your two ♠ winners (sort of) but now you get to play a ♣ through North's ♣K at trick 3.

[showcards W:SK N:SJ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠A, then the ♠K. Dummy follows suit and it is your play to the second trick.

Ruff partner's ♠K.

It is obvious that your side can only get 2 ♠ tricks. And assuming that North has the Ace of trumps you will not make a single trick in the red suits. So you need to make 2 ♣ tricks.

If partner has the ♣ A K then he will take them, but if he has the ♣ A J he cannot win 2 ♣ tricks from his side.

To allow for this situation it will be better to play ♣s